

ID: SOMA-M-P02

Title: Being with the Senses

Duration: 10m 00s (**683** words)

Script Content:

[Practice]

When you're ready, let's begin this practice.

Today we will explore the practice of being with the senses. We will focus on shifting from a state of constant activity to a state of simple awareness, noticing each of our senses one at a time.

There is no need to do anything special to prepare. You don't have to change your surroundings or pause your day completely. You might be indoors or outdoors. You might be in the middle of a task, walking, eating, or simply resting.

When you're ready, begin by bringing awareness to the sense of sight. You can look around softly, without trying to focus on anything. Notice colours, shapes, patterns, light, or shadows. Perhaps there are details you haven't seen before – contrast of colours, interesting shapes.

You don't need to name what you see. If your eyes are feeling tired, it's okay to close them or soften your gaze. You may also look at one small area or glance around gently, whatever feels easiest. Let what you see arrive naturally, at its own pace. If your gaze becomes still, notice the stillness. If your eyes move, notice the movements. Nothing needs to be forced.

[Long Pause] (30s - Visual practice)

Now, gently shift to hearing. Notice sounds nearer to you, or those further away. Some sounds may be softer, some louder. Perhaps some sounds feel nice or pleasant, and some uncomfortable, and that's okay.

[Short Pause] (10s - Listening transition)

Notice that sounds are present, without avoiding or pushing them away. Notice them one at a time, or more than one together. You might even pay attention to silence in between sounds, or how the sounds come and go, rise and fade. One moment at a time, gently attend to sounds in a way that feels safe and comfortable for you.

[Long Pause] (30s - Auditory practice)

And now, invite awareness to the presence of smell. Take a gentle breath through your nose, and notice any scents around you.

[Short Pause] (10s - Olfactory practice)

You may smell something strong, or subtle, or perhaps you smell nothing at all. Some scents may feel familiar, and others new. Attend to them lightly, without needing to identify them.

[Short Pause] (10s - Tactile transition)

Now, gently bring awareness to touch. Invite curiosity to how your body is meeting the surface beneath or around you – perhaps the chair, the table, the floor, or even the ground outside. If you are moving or performing an activity, notice how different parts of your body feel as they move.

Explore any sensations on your skin. Maybe there is warmth, coolness, tightness, relaxation, lightness, or heaviness. Some sensations might feel pleasant, and some might not. That's okay too. Explore being with the sense of touch, without avoiding or pushing anything away. You may also bring attention to the internal sensations of the body, perhaps the rhythm of the breath, or your heartbeat. Allow everything to be a part of this gentle noticing.

[Long Pause] (30s - Tactile practice)

As you are being with the senses, you might notice your attention shifting, moving around. That is completely normal, there is no need to try and control it. Bring your attention to whichever sense feels the most comfortable for you in this moment. You can see, hear, smell, or touch. You can spend more time with one sense. You can return to other senses later if you like.

If thoughts and feelings arise, that's also normal. You don't need to push them away or judge them. Notice them and return to the senses when you feel ready.

[Short Pause] (10s - Attention shift practice)

Invite curiosity to the senses and be with what is present, one moment at a time. Sometimes you might notice more than one sense at the same time. Perhaps you feel the air on your skin while you hear a sound. Maybe you notice a smell and see movement at the same time. There is no right or wrong way to experience this. Attend to what is happening for you, in your own way.

[Short Pause] (10s - Transition to close)

When you're ready, take a few deeper breaths if you like. We will now take the remaining moments to allow the practice to end. Each moment, the senses serve as a reminder to be more present, grounded and connected.

[Pause] (20s - Final integration)

Thank you for your practice.

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